9

Between the Two World Wars

Nazism in Germany and World War II

9.1 After the First World War

In the two previous chapters, you learnt about the First World War, Versailles Treaty, Russian revolution, the Great Depression etc. If we wish to understand the history of the world between 1919 and 1945, we must keep these momentous events constantly in our minds.

The First World War severely affected the economies of most European countries but their efforts to recover were constrained by the Great Depression. This led to rising social tensions within these countries. Many people were also influenced by the Russian revolution and the spread of socialist and communist labour movements. As a result, these countries faced a dilemma. They had to decide which path to follow among the three predominant ideologies of those days - liberal democracy, socialism-communism and conservatism. That decision basically depended on which social and economic class dominated their society.

Liberal democracy opposed dictatorship and favoured an elected, constitutional government in which the elected representatives were answerable to the people. Such governments guaranteed citizens' rights and freedoms and were governed by the rule of law. They depended on consensus, formulating their policies through public debates to avoid social conflict.

Many countries adopted a liberal constitution after 1919 and formed governments based on the provisions contained in their constitutions. However, in practice, the wealthy classes in these countries soon began to dominate economic and political life through corrupt practices, leaving the elected representatives powerless to represent the interests of the people. Countries such as Britain and the United States of America, which were materially wealthy and faced less social conflict, were generally more successful in establishing liberal democracy.

Do you think the Indian political system is a liberal democracy? Clarify with reasons.

How does corruption weaken a liberal political system?

9.2 The conservative movement and fascism

However, anti-liberal movements soon began to gain momentum in many European countries in the socio-political climate that prevailed at that time. These countries had a large middle class that included small and medium peasants, shopkeepers, traders, small industrialists and government employees. This class opposed the wealthy capitalists whose policies were responsible for robbing them of their livelihoods.

Small peasants found their land being auctioned while small shopkeepers and traders were being driven out of business. Unemployment was rising. These classes were, thus, the most severely affected by the Great Depression of 1929.

People belonging to the lower middle class were also strong opponents of the socialist and communist labour movement, which was against private ownership of property.

Struggling to save their small private holdings and small businesses, this class, thus, opposed both liberalism and communism. After 1925, and especially after the recession began in 1929, the people belonging to this class began to mobilise and become politically active. They opposed electoral democracy, liberalism, the rule of law, the principle of equality, socialism and similar ideas. They were also ultra-nationalist in opposing other countries. This ideology was called 'Fascism'. Countries like Germany and Italy soon saw the establishment of new fascist parties.

Fascism has many facets but most fascists shared some common traits:

1. They were ultra-nationalist. They claimed that their nation was supreme. For them, the nation was the majority community in their country. They favoured militarism and sought to establish the sovereignty of their nation globally. They built up war hysteria among their people to achieve their objective.
2. They wanted to eliminate any kind of conflict within their nation, such as class conflict or competition between political parties. They gave unlimited power to the state to resolve all such conflicts and impose its will on the people.
3. They believed in violence and the use of force to eliminate other political parties and organisations.
4. They opposed democracy. Fascism believes that democracy, elections, legal process, citizens' freedom and rights are obstacles in solving the problems of the nation. It believes that one party and the dictatorship of a one-leader government serve the national interest the best.
5. They believed in traditional family and social values, such as women should bear children and look after the home, people in higher positions in society should be respected, the orders of superiors should be obeyed without question, etc. They did not believe in values such as equality, equal opportunity for all, respect for diversity, tolerance etc.
6. They responded without questioning to the call of the supreme party leader, rousing the masses to build up their movement.



Figure 9.1: A Nazi party member humiliates a socialist leader by parading him in the streets in a garbage cart. Look at the distinctive uniform of the activists. They were not government employees.



Figure 9.2: A massive rally in support of Hitler at Nuremberg. Such rallies were staged annually to demonstrate Hitler's supreme power.

Fascism believed in controlled people's mobilisation and maintained the ferver among the people. It controled and used state media to reach its message to the people to stir up mass hysteria.

7. In countries like Germany, fascism took the form of racism. One of the prime objectives of the fascist party of Germany was to establish the superiority and dominance of the majority race which they called the 'Aryan Race'. To achieve this objective, it targeted minority communities and religions, like the Jews, and justified its genocidal treatment of the Jews.

Which classes of people among the following do you think supported fascism – medium and small peasants, the organised working class, shopkeepers, unemployed youth?

What was the attitude of fascists towards the organised labour movement?

What difference do you see between nationalism and ultra-nationalism?

How did fascists propagate a unified viewpoint within the country – through dialogue and making space for everyone's needs or by other means?

What did a fascist party want to establish in place of democracy?

What was the attitude of fascists towards women?

In Italy, the fascist party became active after 1919 under the leadership of Mussolini, killing, beating and using other such methods to destroy the workers' organisations. The party gradually grew into a large and violent movement that discarded democratic methods (petitioning and approaching the courts) to dispense mob justice. However, the fascists were less successful than the socialists and communists



Figure 9.3: Mussolini addressing a massive rally

in the 1921-22 elections. Yet they organised a massive march in 1922 with the objective of capturing Rome, the capital city. The Italian king and other conservatives invited Mussolini to form the government.

After coming to power, the fascists banned all political parties and workers' organisations. They took over control of every facet of life and all functions of the government, establishing one-party rule under Mussolini's undisputed and authoritarian leadership in place of democratic governance.

What differences do you see between a democracy and a fascist dictatorship?

What differences and similarities do you see in the pictures of Hitler's and Mussolini's rallies?

9.3 Germany and Nazism

The National Socialist Workers Party (Nazi party) came to power in Germany in 1934 under the leadership of Adolf Hitler. The party had become very popular among the lower middle classes between 1924 and 1934. There were many reasons for its growing popularity. First, the German people were angry and upset by the humiliating terms of the Versailles Treaty and the war reparations they were forced to pay every year to the victorious nations. Their self-respect was wounded so they were looking for a leader who could revive their national pride. Second, the country was severely affected by the Great Depression from 1929 to 1933, with industrial production falling by more than 50% and unemployment rising rapidly. The people, especially the middle class, were in distress.

The ultra-nationalist Nazi party blamed the Jews and other countries for the troubles the German people were facing. Its popularity, thus, grew rapidly after 1929 and it emerged as the largest party in the 1932 election. During this time, the socialist and communist parties were also gaining popularity and were advocating fundamental social changes just like in Russia. But they could not join hands to oppose Hitler because of their mutual differences and conflicts.

Try to recall the terms of the Versailles Treaty that you learnt about in the previous chapter, which hurt the sentiments and self-respect of the German people.



Figure 9.4 Hitler addressing a rally. He was an impressive speaker who could rouse his audience.

Hitler forged an alliance with the industrialists, landowners and other elite classes. He was appointed chancellor of Germany by the German president Hindenburg, who was worried by the prospect of a communist revolution and the spread of left-wing ideology. Propaganda had played an important role in the Nazi party's quest for power. In his speeches, Hitler vowed to make Germany a powerful nation, oppose the injustice of the Versailles Treaty and restore the lost honour of the German people. He assured the nation that he would resolve the problem of unemployment and free Germany from the clutches of foreign countries. He proclaimed the German Aryan race to be the most superior in the world and blamed the Jews for the country's problems. He claimed that the Jewish people were the owners of all major industries and banks and were responsible for spreading left-wing ideas and for people being unemployed.

Hitler's speeches and Nazi party propaganda incited the people to mass hysteria. Many Jews and opposition party members faced mob fury during this time and were executed in large numbers.

Once he acquired power, Hitler banned democratic groups and institutions. He ordered the arrest of all communist leaders, blaming them for the fire that broke out in the Reichstag building (German Parliament) in February 1933. Citizens' rights were suspended under the Fire Decree (Decree of the Reich President for the Protection of the People and the State) and they remained suspended during the entire tenure of the Nazi party. In March 1933, the Enabling Act was passed. Under this legislation, Hitler dissolved the assembly to gain total authority, running the government by passing ordinances. All political parties and trade unions were banned, except for the Nazi party and its front organisations.

The party and state took over total control of the economy, media, army and judiciary. Special security squads were formed to patrol the entire country and organise it in accordance with Nazi ideology. Units such as the SS (crime control police), Gestapo (secret state police) and HSD (security service) were given unbridled, unconstitutional powers. The entire German society was subjected to Nazification, with the party using armed force to destroy all anti-Nazi groups.

In 1933, many concentration camps were set up in which thousands of political opponents were imprisoned and often put to death. The number of people who were declared traitors and sentenced to death rose to around 30,000 by 1939.

How did Hitler and the Nazi party establish their dictatorship?

9.3.1 The state and society under Nazi rule

The administrative services and army under the Nazi government were loyal to Hitler, not the German nation. It was compulsory for all administrative staff to become members of the front organisations set up by the Nazi party. All cases involving political crimes were transferred from the Supreme Court to Nazi-controlled people's courts, enabling the Nazi government to eliminate all political opposition by so-called legal means.

Labelling the economy a 'war economy', the government focused on heavy industry, in particular the armaments industry.

Prohibitions were placed on forming labour organisations or organising workers' agitations. All workers were enrolled in



Figure 9.5: The cover of a Nazi women's magazine. What party ideals for men and women does this illustration reflect?

Nazi labour unions, which were party propaganda units rather than labour unions.

The Nazi government sought to ensure employment for all under its job creation programme. Extensive road construction, arms manufacture and production of Volkswagen cars were among the main components of this programme. Germany was able to emerge out of the depression because of these efforts. But since the focus of industrialisation was the war, the economy could only grow in a war situation.

The Nazi party propagated a narrow patriarchal perspective of society in which women were expected to stay at home and were glorified for bearing children of pure Aryan stock. The government limited women's enrolment in universities to 10% from the previous 37%. It banned all anti-Nazi art and literature and exercised total control over all media communication.

The Nazis made important changes in the education system to glorify German history and emphasise racism in science. They also removed all Jews from the teaching staff.

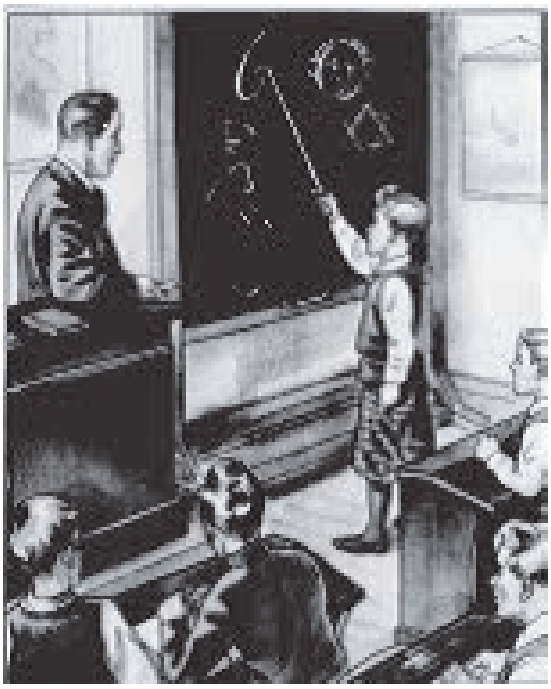


Figure 9.6: 'The noses of Jews are curved like the figure 6' is what German children are taught in a class. They are taught to distinguish themselves from Jews by the shape of their nose.

9.3.2 The holocaust: massacre of the Jews and others

Anti-Semitism (prejudice against Jews) can be traced to the Middle Ages in many European countries. But Hitler used this prejudice to fan hatred of the Jews to monstrous proportions, making the entire German nation strongly anti-Semitic. The Jews were portrayed as an inferior race that was the root cause of all Germany's problems. Jews were stripped of their citizenship in September 1935 and Germans were prohibited from marrying Jews, with such marriages being declared a cognisable offence. Many other prohibitions were imposed on Jews – confiscation and sale of their property, removal from government service, boycott of Jewish businesses, etc.



Figure 9.7: Jewish women and children from Poland being herded into trains carrying them to the concentration camps

On November 9-10, 1938, a massive coordinated attack was carried out against the Jews throughout Germany in

which their property, homes and synagogues were ravaged. This terrible event came to be known as 'The Night of the Broken Glass'. Jews were made to wear identity badges to distinguish them from the rest of the population and they were forcibly herded into ghettos after their property was seized.



Figure 9.8: Thousands of corpses were thrown into mass graves

Around 42,500 concentration camps were set up across Germany, with Hitler announcing that he would eventually exterminate all Jews across Europe. They were transported to these concentration camps from their ghettos and made to work like slaves. Between 1941 and 1945, 60 lakh Jews, including 15 lakh children, were sent to their death in gas chambers in a phased manner. They were stripped naked and packed into these chambers into which poisonous gas was released, killing them in minutes.

Wherever the German army captured territory, they separated the Jews and sent them to the concentration camps where they were subsequently gassed to death. In addition, another 50 lakh non-Jews, including Polish, Russian, nomadic gypsies and mentally and physically handicapped people were also killed because the Nazis felt they would degrade the German race.

This systematic massacre is called the 'Holocaust'. It was the result of racist targeting of a specific minority community and generating mass hysteria and hatred against them.

Imagine the lives of Jewish children across Europe between 1933 and 1945. What do you think they felt and experienced? Discuss in class. Also read 'Hana's suitcase', which is given below.

What was there in racist ideology that you think could have prompted the German people to treat other people in such an inhuman manner?

9.4 Foreign policy and the world war

In early 1933, Hitler gave assurances of adopting peaceful policies, saying his main objective was to terminate the humiliating terms of the Versailles Treaty and gain an honourable status for Germany. But he wanted Germany to regain the territory it had lost in 1919. So he adopted a policy of re-armament and slowly built up a strong army backed by aircraft, tanks and submarines. In 1935, Hitler announced conscription to the air force and army in direct violation of the Versailles Treaty. He also re-integrated the Saar valley into Germany after carrying out a referendum. In March 1936, German

soldiers re-took the Rhineland. Also in 1936, Hitler signed an agreement with Mussolini's fascist Italian government and Japan to jointly oppose Russia in the war. In the same year, he sent his army to the aid of the fascist military dictatorship in Spain to test his new weapons and military systems.

During this period, Hitler assessed that Britain and France weren't keen on entering into a war with Germany. Instead, they wanted to prop him up as a barrier against the Russian communists. This British policy was called the 'appeasement policy'. Taking advantage of it, Hitler captured Austria and Czechoslovakia in 1939.



Figure 9.9: A 1936 satirical cartoon by well-known cartoonist David Low. Hitler is shown walking to his goal on the backs of the 'spineless leaders of democracy'

Towards the end of 1939, he signed a non-aggression pact with Russia under which both countries agreed not to attack each other. In September 1939, Germany invaded and captured Poland. Following the surrender, the Germans rounded up the Jews, intellectuals, elite class, teachers etc in Poland and executed them to prevent the emergence of a new leadership in the country. This inhuman treatment of the Polish population stunned the world.

Hitler also herded the Polish peasants from their villages into camps and sold them as slaves, re-settling the villages with Germans. He said the German people needed place to breathe and live for which it was necessary to eliminate the people of Eastern Europe and confiscate their land. He claimed that the non-German races were inferior and only fit to be slaves. The German soldiers were also told that the enemy soldiers were inferior and could be easily defeated by the German race. This ideology guided his thrust to capture the whole world. He promised the German people that they could exploit the wealth of all the captured countries to raise their living standards.

In 1939, Britain and France declared war on Germany in support of Poland. This step scaled up the war into a world war. Germany quickly worked out its war strategy, attacking northern Europe and France by mid-1940 and entering North Africa to attack Britain's colonies. Italy and Japan declared they would ally with Germany, the three together forming the Axis powers. In 1941, Japan attacked the USA and Germany attacked the Soviet Union (Russia). The entry of the USA and the Soviet Union into the war was a defining moment. Together with Britain, France and other anti-German nations, these two countries formed the Allied powers, also called the United Nations, which later went on to form the United



Figure 9.10 The battle for Stalingrad

Nations Organisation whose primary objective was to defeat the Axis powers.

Russia wasn't militarily prepared to face the German assault in the beginning and was forced to retreat. But in 1942-43, Hitler's victorious army faced defeat for the first time at the hands of the Soviet army in the city of Stalingrad. After that, the Soviets kept advancing till they captured Berlin, the German capital. Hitler committed suicide before the fall of Berlin.

During this phase of the war, Britain and the USA fought together to liberate France, after which they advanced to Berlin. Meanwhile, Mussolini also committed suicide after Italy was defeated. The USA then dropped atomic bombs on the two Japanese cities of Hiroshima and Nagasaki after Berlin was captured to force Japan to surrender, which it immediately did. With this, the Second World War came to an end.

Humanity had never before seen a war as destructive and merciless as the Second World War. On one side, there was Germany's genocide of the Jews and Japan's inhuman treatment of prisoners of war. On the other, dropping atomic bombs on defenceless civilians shook the world's conscience. The war claimed the lives of 225 lakh soldiers and about twice that number – around 500 lakh – of civilians were killed. Around 60 lakh Jews were sent to their death in the holocaust while 2,50,000 people perished in minutes in Nagasaki. Russia suffered the highest number of casualties, the estimates ranging from 200 to 400 lakh, or around 20 percent of the country's population.



Figure 9.11: A scene of the destruction caused by the atom bomb in Nagasaki





Figure 9.12 Hana and her suitcase

HANA'S SUITCASE

Japan built a Holocaust museum to remind people of the horrors of the Second World War. The exhibits in the museum included some materials from the Auschwitz concentration camp, among which a suitcase drew the attention of visitors. It was the suitcase in which a victim of the gas chambers had kept her belongings. Her name was marked on the lid – Hana Brady, May 16, 1931. This orphaned child was killed when she was 13 years old.

Japanese children visiting the museum kept asking many questions about Hana and her suitcase – who was this girl, where was she from, where did she live, how was she orphaned, why was she killed? The director of the museum had no answers to their questions so she decided to investigate. After several years, it came to light that Hana's elder brother was living in Canada. He related Hana's story in a letter.

Hana's family lived in a town called Nove Mesto in the Czech Republic. They were Jews. The travails of the Czech Jews began when the Nazis occupied their country in 1939. They were not allowed to go to school, visit the cinema and so on. They had to wear an identity badge when they ventured out of their homes. Gradually, they were deported to the concentration camps. One day, Hana's mother was taken away and the next day her father. Hana was not yet 11 years old at the time. Her mother sent her a gift from the concentration camp on her birthday. That was the last contact with her.

The brother and sister were now alone in the world. They were both sent to a concentration camp on May 14, 1942 where they lived for two years. On October 23, 1944, Hana was sent to Auschwitz, where she was gassed to death. Her brother was working as a slave at the time that the reign of the Nazis came to an end. He learnt from his paternal aunt that his parents and sister had been killed. He wrote: "My world came to an end at that moment. Even today, I feel Hana's little hands. I regret so much that I could not save her."

From 'Hana's Suitcase' by Karen Levine, published in 2002

The Second World War was the first time in history that more civilians than soldiers were killed in a war. It was also the first war in which all civilians (male and female) had to work for the war effort, with the economy of the countries involved in the fighting almost entirely directed to produce armaments for the war.

In a way, the two world wars in the 20th century were a consequence of the important changes that had taken place in the 19th century, such as the formation of nation states that began to see other nation states as their sworn enemies, industrialisation that made it possible to manufacture huge quantities of armaments, workers who could be sent to the war front for several years, democracies that could incite war hysteria in their people, scientific progress that made it possible to manufacture tanks and machine guns, poison gas chambers, bomber aircraft and the atom bomb, unparalleled for its destructive capability.

The first 50 years of the 20th century witnessed these horrific episodes because human society could not control the institutions it had created for its own well-being. Instead, humans lost their humanity to cross the limits of bestiality.

Compare the First and Second World Wars and state the differences in the weapons used and the destruction caused to life and property.

9.5 India and the Second World War

Once again in 1939, the British government thrust India into the war without consulting the people. The Indian army was despatched to Burma and Singapore to fight the Japanese and to Africa to fight the Germans and Italians. Large quantities of materials such as food-grain and clothing were purchased for the army, leading to a sharp increase in prices and scarcity of goods in the market. The most horrendous consequence of the scarcity was the Bengal famine of 1943 in which 30 lakh people died of starvation or perished in epidemics. The famine didn't occur because of low harvests of grain but because grain was bought in large quantities by the government for the army, leading to the scarcity in the market. Taking advantage of the situation, traders began hoarding grain in the hope of reaping huge profits. The government could have acted to save the people by distributing adequate quantities of grain. But the colonial government did not take any steps in this direction. Indian traders and industrialists, thus, earned huge profits and became wealthy because of the demand created by the war.

The nationalist movement in India was sharply divided on the policy to adopt towards the world war. Some people felt that India should see the war as an opportunity to join hands with Germany and Japan to oust the British from the country. Prominent among them was Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose who organised the Azad Hind army in Singapore with the help of Germany and Japan, advancing towards Nagaland and Manipur. Leaders like Gandhiji, Nehru and Patel were opposed to this line of action. They believed that India should not support the genocidal, anti-democratic policies of Germany and Japan. They felt that India could continue its fight for freedom from British rule without support from Germany. In pursuit of this policy Gandhiji launched the 'Quit India' movement in 1942 in which millions of common people joined with great enthusiasm. The communists, however, felt that defeating Hitler to save global democracy and socialism was the most important immediate priority. Hence, they felt that Britain should not be opposed until the war was over.

Once the war was over, all three streams of thought came together, with Nehru and other Congress leaders striving to protect the Azad Hind soldiers and the Communist Party again becoming active in

the freedom movement. One important outcome of the war was that Britain became weak internationally while the USA and Soviet Union emerged as the most powerful global powers. This created the right conditions for India to win its freedom from British rule.

Have you heard about famines? Find out from your elders how people live during a famine and discuss in class.

The war affected peasants and traders in different ways. What do you think were the reasons for these differences?

9.6 After the Second World War

Soviet Union, USA and Britain were the principal forces that defeated Hitler. These three nations decided that the first priority was to dismantle the Nazi regime and identify the Nazi leaders who could be punished for the human massacres. Punishment was duly meted out to the Nazi leaders for their heinous crimes but only 11 of them were sentenced to death. The rest were either merely imprisoned or received life sentences, which were inadequate, considering the crimes they had committed. This was because the victorious nations didn't want to take an excessively harsh stand against Germany as had been done in Versailles.

The map of Europe was redrawn once again after the war. The regions of Europe that were liberated by the Soviets became part of the Soviet sphere of influence while the remaining regions and Japan came under the influence of the USA. Thus, East Germany came under Russian influence while West Germany came under US influence. Poland, East Germany, Czechoslovakia, Hungary and Yugoslavia were established as independent nations but remained under the Soviet sphere of influence. Similarly, West Germany, France, Holland, Italy, Greece and some other countries also became independent nations but remained under US influence. In Japan, the government remained under the emperor, but fresh elections were held under US supervision and a new government was formed that adopted a new democratic constitution. Both the US and Soviet Russia formulated plans to redevelop the economies under their respective spheres of influence so that the countries whose economies had been destroyed by the war could once again tread the path of progress.



Figure 9.13: The victorious leaders Stalin (USSR), Roosevelt (USA) and Churchill (Britain) in Teheran in 1943

Meanwhile, a proposal was formulated to carve out a new nation for the Jews from their traditional city of Jerusalem and

the adjoining areas. This land belonged to the people of Palestine so the Arabs protested against the formation of the new nation in their midst. However, the Jewish state was established in 1948 with the help of the US government and was called Israel.

Germany was divided in 1945. Find out whether the country is still divided today.

9.7 The United Nations Organisation

Attempts to form a new international organisation began from the time Germany was staring at defeat in the war. The leaders of Britain, Soviet Russia and the USA met several times to discuss the future global order and the framework of the proposed organisation. After the war ended in October 1945, 50 countries together formed the United Nations Organisation (UNO, presently called the UN). Its main objective was to establish world peace and encourage mutual support and cooperation between countries for their economic development. Its guiding principles were: respect for the internal power structure of every country, justice in international relations, and encouraging human rights and social development within countries.

The reasons for the failure of the earlier League of Nations were borne in mind while constituting the new organisation. The League of Nations was run on the basis of consensus between its main member countries and it had no statutory power to enforce its decisions. In forming the UN, attention was paid to ensuring that the main member nations had the required military strength to enforce any major decision that had their backing. At that time, five major countries were given a special place in the organisation – the USA, Britain, France, Soviet Union and China. These five countries were made permanent members of the United Nations Security Council (UNSC), each having the power to reject a decision to which objections were raised. This power was called veto right. If there was consensus between these five nations on an issue then they could jointly implement it.

In addition to the Security Council, the UN also had a General Assembly constituted by all its member nations in which many issues are discussed and decisions taken. Apart from this, an International Court of Justice (ICJ) was also established to settle disputes between countries, ensure observance of international law and oversee proper implementation of treaties. Several agencies were set up to foster development and cooperation between nations, such as the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organisation (UNESCO), United Nations International Children's Emergency Fund (UNICEF), World Health Organisation (WHO), International Labour Organisation (ILO), United Nations Commission for Human Rights (UNCHR), etc.

Despite the many problems it has been facing over the past 70 years, the UN continues to work for world peace, development and cooperation and has, till now, successfully diffused issues that could escalate into a Third World War.

EXERCISES

1. Identify the wrong statements in the following and rectify them:
    a) Britain's ambitions led to the outbreak of the Second World War.
    b) The League of Nations was formed in 1945.
    c) Fascism opposed a multi-party system.
    d) Organised labour was the biggest supporter of fascism.
    e) Japan supported Britain in the Second World War.

2. Fill in the blanks with the correct option:

   a) ……was the fascist dictator of Italy. (Hitler, Stalin, Mussolini)

   b) Hitler suspended all citizens' rights with the ……. Law passed in 1933. (Fire Decree, Jewish Decree, Enabling Act)

   c) Germany, Italy and …… together were called the Axis powers. (Japan, France, Russia)

   d) ……..…… was established as a nation for the Jews in 1948. (Japan, France, Israel)

3. Give brief answers to the following questions:

   a) What was the condition of the small property owners after the First World War?

   b) What assurances did Hitler give the German people?

   c) How did Germany treat the Polish people after the country was occupied?

   d) What was the reason for the Bengal famine of 1943?

   e) What incident led Japan to agree to surrender?

4. What are the differences between fascism and liberal democracy? Explain in detail.

5. Why did Hitler want to expand the German state?

6. What differences do you see between nationalism and ultra-nationalism?

7. What do you think was the cause of Germany's defeat?

8. Had Germany won the war, what impact do you think it would have had on the world?

9. The United Nations Security Council gives special rights to five countries. Why was this done? Do you think it is correct? Write what you think.

Project Work

1. Imagine you a Jewish boy or girl. Write a story about what happened to you and your family between 1933 and 1945.

2. Prepare a poster exibition on either the Holocast or the bombing of Hiroshima and Nagasaki.